Storm Rachel Gets Weaker but Brings More Rain

From: NPR World Mined: 2026-10-12 3 min read

A storm named Rachel caused flooding and damage in Southern California over the weekend. On Sunday, the National Weather Service said Rachel had become weaker. It is now called a **post-tropical storm**. It can still bring heavy rain and wind.

The storm moved **inland** across the desert Southwest. The weather service warned of **flash floods**. Big waves kept hitting towns on the coast.

In beach cities like Long Beach and Newport Beach, waves broke through sand walls built to hold back the ocean. Some homes near the water were partly underwater. Las Vegas broke a rainfall record for one day. Utah, including Salt Lake City, was told to watch for floods.

Forecasters think Rachel may be a sign of more storms. They expect the strongest **El Niño** on record this winter. **El Niño** is when parts of the Pacific Ocean get warmer than usual, which can change the weather.

California is getting ready. The state is setting out more than 4 million sandbags and checking its dams.

Word Treasure

post-tropical storm -- A storm that has lost some of its tropical strength but can still bring rain and wind.

inland -- Away from the ocean, toward the middle of the land.

flash floods -- Floods that happen very fast after a lot of rain.

Forecasters -- People who study the weather and tell us what it will be like.

El Niño -- A time when parts of the Pacific Ocean get warmer than usual and change the weather.

Background you need

Big storms like Rachel start over warm ocean water and usually get weaker when they move over land.

Weather experts warn people about floods so they can stay safe.

Sandbags are bags filled with sand that people stack up to keep water out.

Break it down

WHO: Storm Rachel, the National Weather Service and people in California, Las Vegas and Utah
WHAT: Rachel weakened to a post-tropical storm after causing floods and big waves
WHERE: Southern California beaches, the desert Southwest, Las Vegas and Utah
WHY: Rachel still carried heavy rain, and a strong El Niño may bring more storms

Why it matters

Knowing about storms and floods helps families get ready and stay safe.

Test what you remember

1. What is the storm's name?

- (A) Rachel
- (B) Utah
- (C) Simon
- (D) Isaias

2. What happened to Rachel on Sunday?

- (A) It became weaker
- (B) It got stronger
- (C) It went to Europe
- (D) It turned into snow

3. Which city broke a rainfall record for one day?

- (A) San Diego
- (B) Newport Beach
- (C) Las Vegas
- (D) Long Beach

4. What broke through the sand walls in beach cities?

- (A) Big waves
- (B) Strong sunshine
- (C) Cars
- (D) Snow

5. What do forecasters expect this winter?

- (A) The strongest El Niño on record
- (B) No storms at all
- (C) A very dry winter in Utah
- (D) Only sunny days

6. How is California getting ready?

- (A) Moving everyone to Utah
- (B) Setting out more than 4 million sandbags and checking dams
- (C) Building a new ocean
- (D) Closing all beaches forever

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: C 4: A 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. National Weather Service: Says Rachel is weaker but flash floods are still possible.
2. Forecasters: Think Rachel may be a sign of more storms this winter.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):